Karen Yi

EXPERIENCE

Illinois Digital Service, Remote — *Service Designer*

May 2026 - Present (part time)

- Conducted 7 user interviews with labor advocates and workers for an Illinois Department of Labor website redesign.
- Established style guide and created high-fidelity wireframes in Figma. Built pages in Adobe Experience Manager and wrote custom CSS. Incorporated user feedback in 2-week sprints

American Institutes for Research, Remote — *Data Associate*

September 2022 - Present

- Created accessible 508-compliant documentation (`bookdown`, `data.table`) for users of a dataset from the federal National Assessment for Educational Progress (NAEP), with over 100,000 observations. Presented work at 2024 AERA conference
- Developed charts in d3 and React using a trunk-based CI/CD GitHub workflow and 2-week Jira Agile sprints to deploy privacy-protected feedback application in Django and AWS, used by 90+ teachers in NYC
- Conducted 10 user experience tests to diagram and develop an automated ticketing system in Airtable, which helped manage a process for reporting COVID learning losses to 100s of Illinois schools.
- Led team of 3 to build dashboards with Docker and Shiny for visualizing school finances for the Oregon legislature. Trained team of 3 generating 1000s of automated PDFs to evaluate social learning for Nevada DoE
- Used LLMs, natural language processing, large language models, and topic modeling techniques in Python to read and analyze over 10,000 research abstracts from PDFs and research APIs. Created time series to track trends in education research (`nltk, tika, requests, spacy`)

Depression Grand Challenge, Los Angeles — *UI/UX Designer*

November 2019 - October 2020

- Collaborated with marketing/web teams to prototype wireframes for user-facing website and personal dashboards related to a mental health screening and tracking product available to students across Los Angeles

SKILLS

R, Python, HTML/CSS, LaTeX, JS, SQL, MATLAB, Stata, C++, Figma, Airtable, Adobe Photoshop/Illustrator, Qualtrics, WordPress/Weebly, GitHub, Google Suite, Microsoft Office/Teams, Atlassian/Jira, Slack, Asana

AWARDS

Google Hack for Accessibility Students 2nd Place — 2025

Foreign Languages and Area Studies Scholar — 2024

Carolyn Smith Education Award — 2021

Presidential Public Service Fellow — 2021

UCLA Undergraduate Research Fellow — 2021

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese — limited working proficiency

notkarenyi@gmail.com **(720) 243-6851** **linkedin.com/notkarenyi**

notkarenyi.github.io

EDUCATION

University of Chicago — *M.S. in Computer Science and Public Policy*

September 2023 - June 2025

Relevant coursework: User Interaction and User Experience (UIUX), Software Engineering for Civic Tech, Organizational Theory, Writing for Public Policy, Cloud Computing, Linear Algebra, Machine Learning, Databases

University of California, Los Angeles — *Psychobiology B.S., Minors in Education & Computing*

September 2018 - June 2022

Relevant coursework: Design Culture, Organizational Psychology, Psychology Research Methods, Programming I-II, Communications, Educational Neuroscience, Education Policy, Statistics I-II

PROJECTS

Data Journalist — *Colorado Sun*

April 2026 - present

- Analyzed data and used Flourish to develop 5 graphics for 2 stories about ICE raids and immigrant rights in collaboration with journalist at award-winning local newsroom

BILLinois — *Co-Founder, Chief Architect, and QA Engineer*

January 2025 - November 2025

- Pitched idea for a legislative tracker and civic engagement tool to an audience of 40 students and staff. Developed 3 user stories from 5 interviews to use for iterating on high-fidelity prototypes in Figma
- Formed team of 6 and led the documentation, architecture, and QA processes for 8-week MVP build, resulting in a fully functional legislative tracker that users can utilize to track legislation in Illinois via email alerts

UChicago Maroon Student Newspaper — *Data Journalist*

August 2024 - January 2026

- Created and published 5 standalone graphics illustrating finance news articles using JavaScript (`highcharts`)
- Pitched, developed, and published a long-form investigative piece covering 50 years of pro-divestment organizing at the University of Chicago

Chrysalis — *Volunteer Career Re-entry Coach*

January 2023 - May 2023

- Using non-hierarchical facilitation approach, provided free in-person job interview practice and skills training to over 50 clients re-entering the workforce after chronic illness, incarceration, and other challenges

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